Fiscal Year:	FY 2005	**Task Last Updated:**	FY 04/18/2005
PI Name:	McIntyre, Bradley W Ph.D.		
Project Title:	Gravity and Integrin Mediated Human Lymphocyte Adhesion		
Division Name:	Space Biology		
Program/Discipline:	SPACE BIOLOGY		
Program/Discipline--Element/Subdiscipline:	SPACE BIOLOGY--Cellular and molecular biology		
Joint Agency Name:		**TechPort:**	No
Human Research Program Elements:	None		
Human Research Program Risks:	None		
Space Biology Element:	(1) Cell & Molecular Biology		
Space Biology Cross-Element Discipline:	(1) Immunology		
Space Biology Special Category:	(1) Cell Culture		
PI Email:	bmcintyr@mdanderson.org	**Fax:**	FY 713-563-3357
PI Organization Type:	UNIVERSITY	**Phone:**	713-563-3224
Organization Name:	University of Texas M.D. Anderson Cancer Center		
PI Address 1:	Department of Immunology, Unit 902, P.O. Box 301402		
PI Address 2:	1515 Holcombe Boulevard		
PI Web Page:			
City:	Houston	**State:**	TX
Zip Code:	77030	**Congressional District:**	25
Comments:			
Project Type:	Ground	**Solicitation / Funding Source:**	2000 Space Biology 00-OBPR-01
Start Date:	07/15/2001	**End Date:**	07/14/2007
No. of Post Docs:	1	**No. of PhD Degrees:**	
No. of PhD Candidates:	3	**No. of Master' Degrees:**	
No. of Master's Candidates:	4	**No. of Bachelor's Degrees:**	
No. of Bachelor's Candidates:	0	**Monitoring Center:**	NASA ARC
Contact Monitor:		**Contact Phone:**	
Contact Email:			
Flight Program:			
Flight Assignment:			
Key Personnel Changes/Previous PI:			
COI Name (Institution):			
Grant/Contract No.:	NAG 2-1505		
Performance Goal No.:			
Performance Goal Text:			
	The broad, long term objectives of this proposal are to determine the alterations in normal cellular behavior that are responsible for the defects in lymphocyte function and immunity seen in astronauts returning from space. This proposal will utilize an earth-based Microgravity Analog Culture System (MACS) as a platform to investigate the impact caused randomization of gravity on the basic cellular and biochemical mechanisms of integrin-mediated human lymphocyte adhesion, signaling, and spreading. Our preliminary studies revealed a MACS-induced alteration in integrin a4b1-mediated lymphocyte avidity, spreading, and pseudopodia extension on VCAM-1 and fibronectin. Expression levels of integrin a4b1 was not altered, nor was affinity. Thus, the hypothesis of this proposal is that microgravity alters leukocyte adhesive interactions by influencing the function and not the expression of the integrin a4b1. The specific aims of the proposal are: (1) Confirm and extend the observation that MACS affects the function but not expression of the integrin a4b1, (2) Determine whether integrin affinity or cellular avidity is altered by MACS, (3) Define alterations		

Task Description:	in the integrin adhesion and signaling complex in MACS-treated cells, and (4) Investigate whether the MACS effect can be controlled by pharmacologic or genetic approaches. Quantitative techniques for measuring cell spreading, molecular affinity, and cellular avidity will be employed to compare MACS treated with untreated cells. Fluorescence digital microscopy and conventional biochemistry will be used to analyze the location and signal transduction capacity of integrins after MACS treatment. Cells altered by pharmacologic reagents or transfection of mutant signaling proteins will be examined for abrogation of the MACS induced effects. The identification of defects caused by microgravity will lay the foundation for the development of novel methods for controlling lymphocyte behavior and potentially allowing deleterious effects of microgravity to be eliminated and a normal immune response maintained or restored in astronauts. The objective is to determine the lesion caused by microgravity in cellular adhesion and subsequent biological processes such as cell movement and motility. It is not clear how microgravity alters the immune response. Our research has pinpointed an alteration in lymphoycte behavior caused by simulated microgravity in a rotating wall vessel. Specficially, cellular adhesion is inhibited. This would cause a fundamental change in cellular movement and recognition during the initiation and maintenance of an immune response.
Rationale for HRP Directed Research:	
Research Impact/Earth Benefits:	The proposed research will utilize an Earth-based Microgravity Analog Culture System (MACS) to randomize g and basic cellular and biochemical mechanisms of integrin-mediated lymphocyte adhesion, spreading, and signaling will be examined. The hypothesis of this proposal is that MACS impinges on lymphocyte physiology by influencing the function but not the expression of integrins. Specific Aims: Specific aim #1: Confirm and extend the observation that MACS affects the function but not expression of the integrin a4b1. Specific aim #2: Determine whether integrin affinity or cellular avidity is altered by MACS. Specific aim #3: Define alterations in the integrin adhesion and signaling complex in MACS treated cells. Specific aim #4: Investigate whether the MACS effect can be controlled by pharmacologic or genetic approaches.
Task Progress:	The research utilizes Rotating Wall Vessel bioreactors as an Earth-based system to investigate the impact caused by randomization of gravity on the basic cellular and biochemical mechanisms of integrin-mediated human lymphocyte adhesion, signaling, and spreading. We have found a defect in cellular spreading. In soluble ligand-binding assays the affinity of the integrins did not seem to be altered but overall cellular avidity was reduced as determined by quantitative cell adhesion assays utilizing parallel plate flow chambers. Molecular tweezer experiments, which can be used to measures forces at the molecular level, confirm these results. The decrease in cellular avidity for extracellular matrix components can explain the original defect observed in cellular spreading. Current studies focus on determining the alterations in key intracellular signaling and structural molecules caused by culture in the rotating wall vessel.
Bibliography Type:	Description: (Last Updated: 03/17/2008)
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	McIntyre, B.W "Effects of Simulated Microgravity on Integrin Function in Human Lymphocytes" American Society of Cell Biology 43rd Annual Meeting, San Francisco, California . , Jan-2004
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Andruss, B.F., S.A. Lopez, M. Arya, B. Anvari, and B.W. McIntyre "Molecular and cellular alterations induced by simulated microgravity in lymphocytes" 2004 NASA Cell Science Conference, Palo Alto, CA . , Feb-2004
Abstracts for Journals and Proceedings	Andruss, B.F., S.A. Lopez, M. Arya, B. Anvari, and B.W. McIntyre "Force Measurements with Molecular Tweezers Reveal Reduced Integrin-Mediated Adhesion in Human Lymphocytes Cultured in Simulated Microgravity" The American Society for Cell Biology, 43rd Annual Meeting, San Francisco, California . , Jan-2004
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Anvari, B, J.H. Torres, and B.W. McIntyre "Regulation of pseudopodia localization in lymphocytes by application of mechanical forces" Journal of Biomedical Optics 9(5):865-872, 2004 , Jan-2004
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	McIntyre, B.W., S.A. Lopez, J.S. Mitchell "Effects of simulated microgravity on integrin function in human lymphocytes" (in preparation). , Mar-2005
Articles in Peer-reviewed Journals	Andruss, B.F., S.A. Lopez, M. Arya, B. Anvari, and B.W. McIntyre "Force measurements indicate reduced integrin function in lymphocytes cultured in simulated microgravity " (in preparation). , Mar-2005
Presentation	McIntyre, B.W. "Effects of Simulated Microgravity on Integrin Function in Human Lymphocytes" American Society of Cell Biology 43rd Annual Meeting, San Francisco, California Jan-2004